4.2.2 Processing

Poultry is marketed in ready to cook form as dressed chicken after removing the head, feet and entrails. After the birds are killed, they are scalded, that is, dipped in hot water briefly. The temperature of the scald water may be 60 ^{0}C and the bird is kept in it for about 45 seconds or more. Scalding loosens the feathers on the chicken and thus helps defeathering.



Fig 4.6: Cuts of Chicken

After defeathering, evisceration of the bird takes place. The eviscerated birds are thoroughly washed and chilled. Chicken can be purchased whole, cut into parts or in packs of similar individual parts, such as breasts, drum sticks or thighs.

4.2.3 Composition and nutritive value

Poultry meat has high protein content (about 25 percent) and is comparable in quality and nutritive value to other meats. It contains all the essential amino acids required for building body tissues. There is a little fat on the meat of young birds, but the fat content is influenced by age and species of poultry.

ACTIVITY - 1

Conduct a 10-minute review relay. Divide the class into three or four teams of up to 10 students. Give each team a different coloured marker and ask them to name their team. One student at a time from each team must write one thing they have learned about meat and poultry. The student then returns to the team and hands the pen to another member. Each student must write something different than the previous learning facts. The winning team is the one with the most new facts.

Chicken fat is more unsaturated than the fat of red meat and this has nutritional advantage. Because of its high protein to fat ratio, poultry meat is advantageous to persons who must restrict the intake of fats. Like other animal tissues, poultry flesh is a good source of B Vitamins and minerals.

4.2.4 Selection of poultry

When purchasing fresh poultry, look for firm birds with plump flesh the skin should not look wrinkled. If buying frozen chicken, check that the package is well sealed.

4.3 Fish

India has a coast line of 5,100 km. Over 200 edible fish varieties are known to be commercially important. Marine fishes are sardines, mackerel, tuna, catfish, brown duck, ribbon fish, prawns and cuttle. Fresh

Table 4.2 Nutritive value of Poultry (per 100 g)

Food	Energy (Kcal)	Protein (g)	Fat (g)	Calcium (mg)	Iron (mg)
Chicken	109	25.9	0.6	25	-

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